Phase 0 · Production document

Episode 1 Beat Sheet and Level Layout

ផ្នែះបុណ្យ

Every beat, trigger, item and patrol in order, with scaled maps of each area. The greybox is built directly from this document.

Based on	Episode 1 specification v3.1 · Story Bible v1.0
Target length	1 h 35 – 1 h 55 for a first-time player
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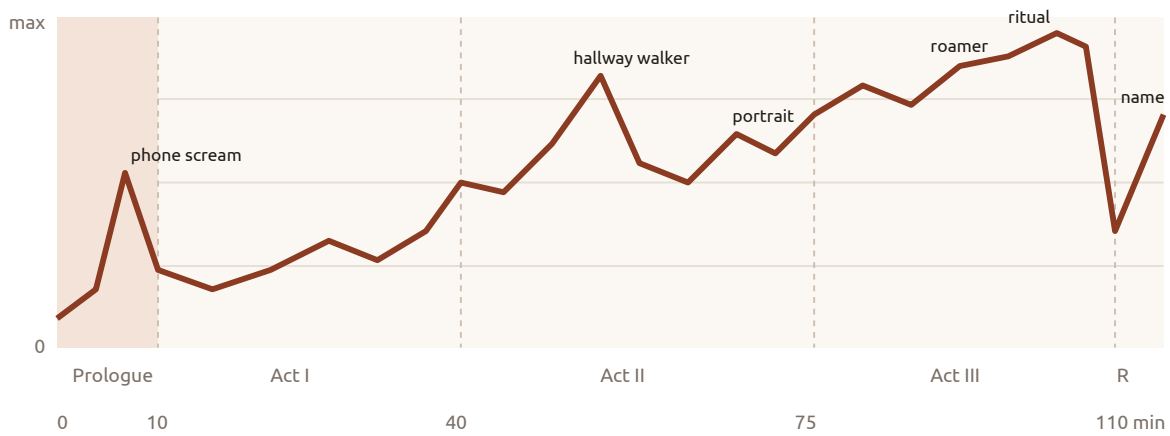
08 Greybox Checklist

01 How to Use This Document

The episode specification says *what* happens. This document says *exactly where, when and how*, at a level of detail you can build from.

Beat IDs	`P01` (prologue), `A1-01`, `A2-01`, `A3-01`, `R01` (resolution). Use the same IDs in code comments, trigger names and bug reports.
Times	**Play** = minutes into the episode for an average first-time player. **Clock** = in-game time.
Flags	Story flags use the format `ep1.<topic>.<state>`. See the Technical Design Document for the full system.
Scale	All dimensions are in metres. Maps are drawn to scale; the scale bar on each map shows 5 m.
Values	Times, speeds and counts are targets to tune in playtesting.

02 Pacing and Tension Curve



Target tension over playtime. Each spike is followed by a release (exploration, a puzzle, a safe moment). The final spike after the ritual is the emotional, not physical, shock of finding Sora's name.

Section	Play	Goal for the player's feelings
Prologue	0–10	Calm, then sudden dread. Learn the controls without noticing.
Act I	10–40	Unease and duty. Learn the routines; nothing attacks.
Act II	40–75	Investigation interrupted by the first real threat; the portrait shock.
Act III	75–105	Sustained pressure: darkness spreading, the roamer, a deadline.
Resolution	105–110	Relief at dawn, then a quiet personal shock.

03 Beat Sheet

3.1 Prologue · Phnom Penh studio

ID	Play	Clock	Beat and player action	Result · flags
P01	0:00	8:00 PM	Fade in at the drafting table. Rain on the window. On-screen text only for the first input hints (look, move), drawn as faint pencil marks that fade.	Movement tutorial.
P02	0:01	8:02	Player examines the half-finished illustration; Sora's hand inks a line.	Teaches interaction.
P03	0:02	8:05	Open the desk drawer: the bundle of Yay Mey's unopened letters. Sora hesitates, then takes them.	`ep1.letters.taken` · item: letters (lore, unread)
P04	0:04	8:10	Collect the starting kit: satchel (shelf), sketchbook (desk), matchbox (drawer), hurricane lamp (hook by door). Picking up the satchel opens it once to teach the inventory.	Inventory tutorial. Door blocked until all four items are collected.
P05	0:07	8:12	Ink spills across the sketchbook; the shelf candle goes out; the clock stops at 8:12. Player is free to look around.	Audio: clock stop. Sketchbook gains the ink-blot page.
P06	0:08	8:12	The telephone rings. Player must lift the earpiece. Yay Mey's call (script `E1-P06`), the scream, glass breaking, dead line.	First spike.
P07	0:10	—	Sora leaves through the door. Fade to black; sound of a train, then a carriage in rain. Title card: *Night 3*.	Checkpoint `CP1`.

3.2 Act I · Arrival and the vigil

ID	Play	Clock	Beat and player action	Result · flags
A1-01	0:10	11:30 PM	The carriage stops at the flooded road; the driver refuses to go on (script). Player lights the lamp (match tutorial) and walks the 60 m path through the banana grove.	Lamp and match tutorial. Oil starts draining.
A1-02	0:12	11:35	The grove opens onto the courtyard. First view of the white funeral tent glowing in the rain. Non-interactive 3-second slowdown.	Mood beat.
A1-03	0:13	11:36	Yay Mey greets Sora under the tent (script `E1-A1-03`), including the reproach about the memorials. Vuthy stands by the coffin.	Story.
A1-04	0:15	11:40	Vuthy speaks with Sora (script `E1-A1-04`), then leaves for town on foot towards the road; his lantern fades into the grove.	`ep1.vuthy.left`
A1-05	0:17	11:45	Yay Mey gives the three duties (script). Each is written into the sketchbook as a small drawing (lamp, incense, thread).	Sketchbook objectives page.

ID	Play	Clock	Beat and player action	Result · flags
A1-06	0:19	11:50	Yay Mey asks for the betel offering "as your mother used to", then goes upstairs to rest in her room (door closes).	Objective: betel tray. Incense timer starts (12 min).
A1-07	0:20	11:50	Free exploration: courtyard, ground floor, upper hall, kitchen. Sok's room is locked ("Not yet. Not his room."). Optional: inspect the protective thread.	Player learns the space.
A1-08	0:22	—	Betel tray puzzle: find Kanha's drawing by the altar; collect betel leaves and areca nut (kitchen), lime pot (hall shelf), candle and incense (altar).	Section 6.1 of the episode spec.
A1-09	0:28	12:15 AM	Place the tray on the altar. Yay Mey's voice from behind her door blesses the matches (script).	Item: sanctified matches ×3 · `ep1.betel.done` · respect +1 if correct first try
A1-10	0:30	12:20	First incense burn-out warning (if not yet replaced): the tent dims, whispers rise. Player replaces sticks from the house altar.	Teaches the incense loop.
A1-11	0:32	—	**Optional:** sewing-box key (hall) → storage shed: two oil bottles, the 1911 land deed and Kanha's photograph.	Lore L4, L5 · `ep1.shed.opened`
A1-12	0:38	12:55	Act I ends when the betel tray is done and at least one incense cycle has passed, at the next time Sora is under the tent.	Triggers A2-01.

3.3 Act II · The unbroken taboo

ID	Play	Clock	Beat and player action	Result · flags
A2-01	0:40	1:00 AM	A cold gust blows out every hanging lamp in the tent. Only the incense and Sora's lamp remain. Heavy wet footsteps cross the floor above.	Checkpoint `CP2`. Spike.
A2-02	0:41	1:01	Player goes upstairs. Sok's door, locked before, now stands ajar.	Sok's room unlocked.
A2-03	0:43	1:05	In Sok's room: a loose wall plank by the desk hides the first journal pages (the pact, the payments, the seals).	Sketchbook: "the pact" page.
A2-04	0:46	1:10	The gramophone starts by itself, playing the chant backwards. Player inspects it; the speed dial becomes interactive.	Gramophone puzzle starts.
A2-05	0:49	1:15	Correct speed: Sok's recorded message (script `E1-A2-05`): the seventh night, the seals, and that the drawer key is "where the ancestors keep watch" (the hall altar's base).	`ep1.gramophone.solved` · sketchbook: seven circles drawn.
A2-06	0:52	1:20	**Hallway walker.** As Sora leaves Sok's room, dragging footsteps climb the front stairs. She must put out or shutter the lamp and hide (wardrobe H1 in Sok's room, or H2 in the hall). The walker crosses the veranda and hall, pauses at Sok's door, and leaves by the rear.	Checkpoint `CP3` just before. Being caught → restart CP3.

ID	Play	Clock	Beat and player action	Result · flags
A2-07	0:56	1:25	Retrieve the drawer key from the altar base; open Sok's desk drawer: the rest of the journal, including the chest behind the planks and the key broken into three pieces "given to the water jars below".	Objective: key fragments.
A2-08	1:02	1:35	Optional lore in the house: journal page L1 (altar drawer), L3 (Sok's wardrobe).	Lore.
A2-09	1:05	1:40	Back under the tent: all four incense sticks are white ash, whatever the player did (scripted). The portrait's eyes are open. Camera does not force the look; a sound cue draws the eye.	Spike. Does not count against respect.
A2-10	1:08	1:45	Player relights the incense. Act II ends after this or 2 minutes, whichever comes first.	Triggers A3-01.

3.4 Act III · The first seal

ID	Play	Clock	Beat and player action	Result · flags
A3-01	1:10	2:00 AM	A loud snap: the protective thread breaks on the tent's north side. The courtyard's remaining lamps begin going out, one every 30 seconds.	Checkpoint `CP4`. Courtyard darkens over 4 minutes.
A3-02	1:11	2:01	The corpse "watched/unwatched" behaviour starts: each time Sora looks away from the coffin for 4+ seconds, Sok's position changes (5 poses, never repeating).	Dread device; no damage.
A3-03	1:13	2:05	Player enters the under-house area. The roamer is introduced by sound only (dragging, wet breath) before it is seen.	Checkpoint `CP5` at the entry.
A3-04	1:14	2:05–2:30	Search six clay jars (J1–J6). Fragments are in J2, J4 and J6; J3 holds lore L2; J1 and J5 hold oil. Opening a jar lid makes noise (medium). The roamer hunts by sound and moves towards an open lamp.	Fragments ×3 · `ep1.fragments.3`
A3-05	1:28	2:35	Combine the fragments in the satchel. Climb back to Sok's room; pull the loose planks; open the chest.	Bronze Token, map, folded slip (unread).
A3-06	1:32	2:45	Sketchbook updates: "Before three. The burner. The blessed matches." A distant clock chimes the quarter hour.	Objective: ritual before 3:00.
A3-07	1:34	2:50	**Ritual.** At the main incense burner: place the token, strike a sanctified match, light. A 25-second hold while the mantra plays. The presence stands behind Sora; its shadow grows on the tent cloth; breathing at the player's ear. Turning the camera more than 100° from the burner fails the ritual.	Checkpoint `CP6` before. Fail → retry with the remaining sanctified matches; with none left, a spare is found at the altar.
A3-08	1:38	3:00	The token burns. Wind tears through the tent; the screech fades. Lamps relight one by one.	`ep1.seal1.broken`

3.5 Resolution · The fourth name

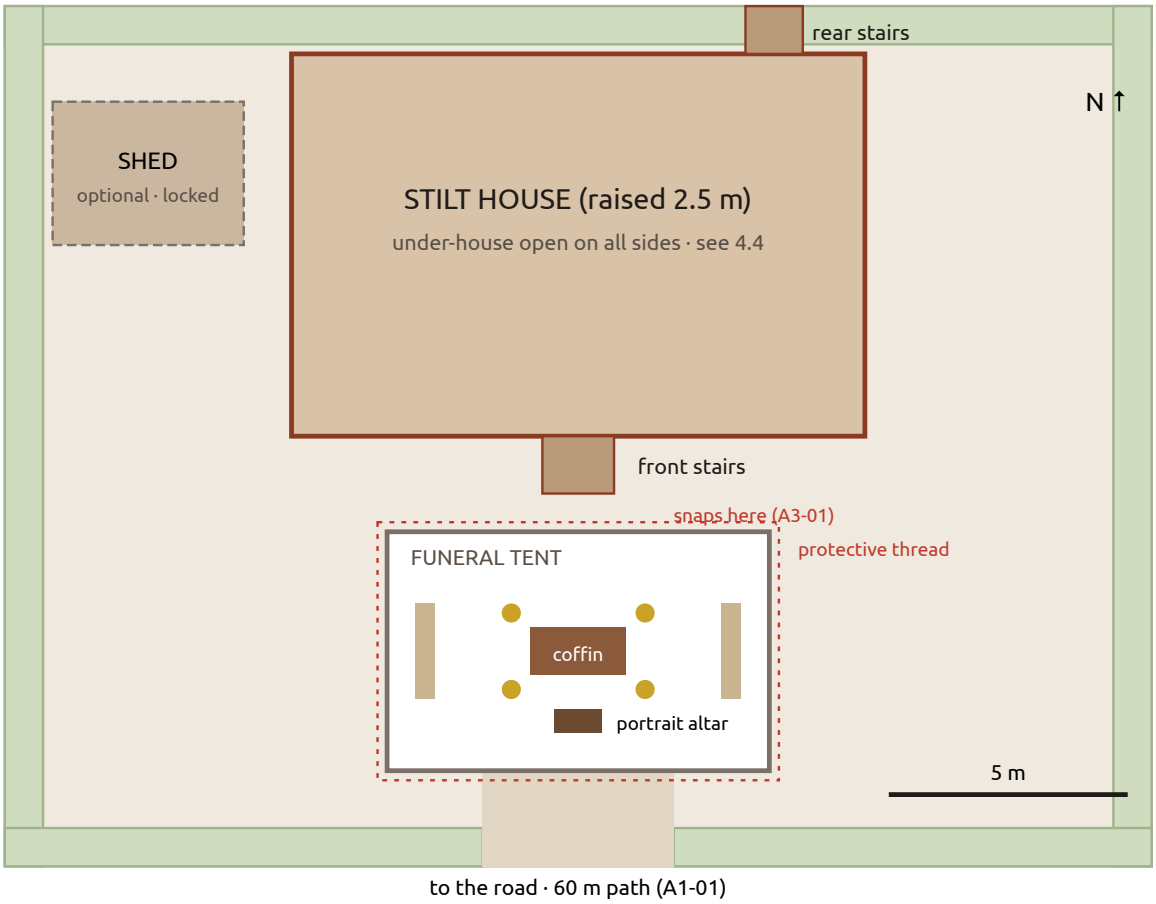
ID	Play	Clock	Beat and player action	Result · flags
R01	1:39	~5:30 AM	Time skip (short fade). Grey pre-dawn light, birdsong, the rain stopped. Sok's body lies still.	Release.
R02	1:40	5:35	Vuthy returns up the path and asks what happened (script `E1-R02`). **Key choice:** show him the journal, or keep it.	`ep1.journal.shared` = true / false
R03	1:42	5:40	Vuthy goes inside to Yay Mey. Sora sits on the tent's edge and unfolds the slip: four names, three crossed out, the fourth scraped and rewritten: **Sora**. No music; rain dripping from the tent.	Emotional spike.
R04	1:43	5:42	Blood seeps across the map, darkening the first faint mark: the village pagoda. Sora fills in the third of seven circles.	Night count 3/7.
R05	1:44	—	Fade to black. Text: *Four nights remain.* Episode summary page in the sketchbook (lore found, respect icons), then credits.	Episode save · end.

04 Level Layout and Maps

4.1 Phnom Penh studio (prologue)

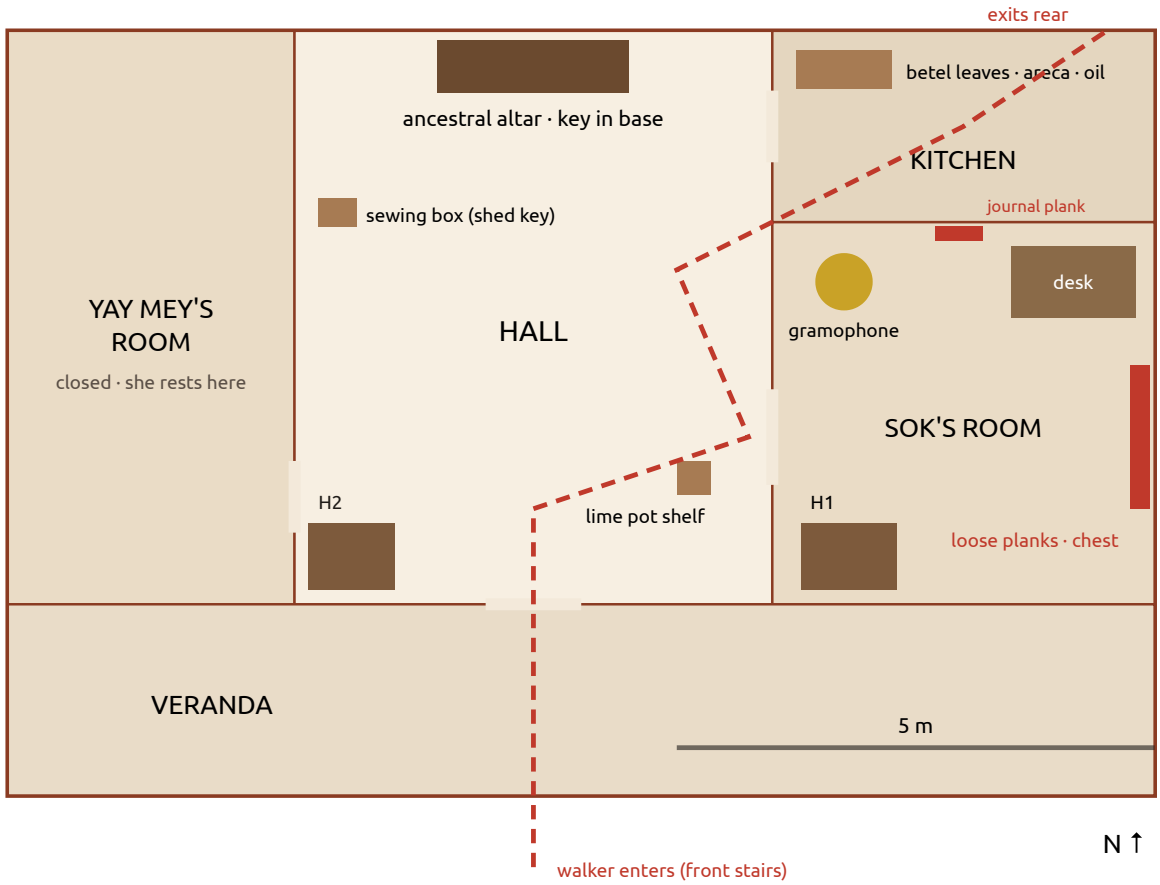
Size	Single room 6 × 5 m, ceiling 3.2 m, third floor. One door (east), one tall window (south).
Furniture	Drafting table under the window; desk with drawer on the west wall; shelf with candle and satchel (north); brass wall telephone by the door; wall clock above the desk; coat hook with the hurricane lamp by the door.
Lighting	Green glass desk lamp (key light), candle (fill), lightning through the window every 20–40 s.

4.2 Site plan: courtyard, tent and house



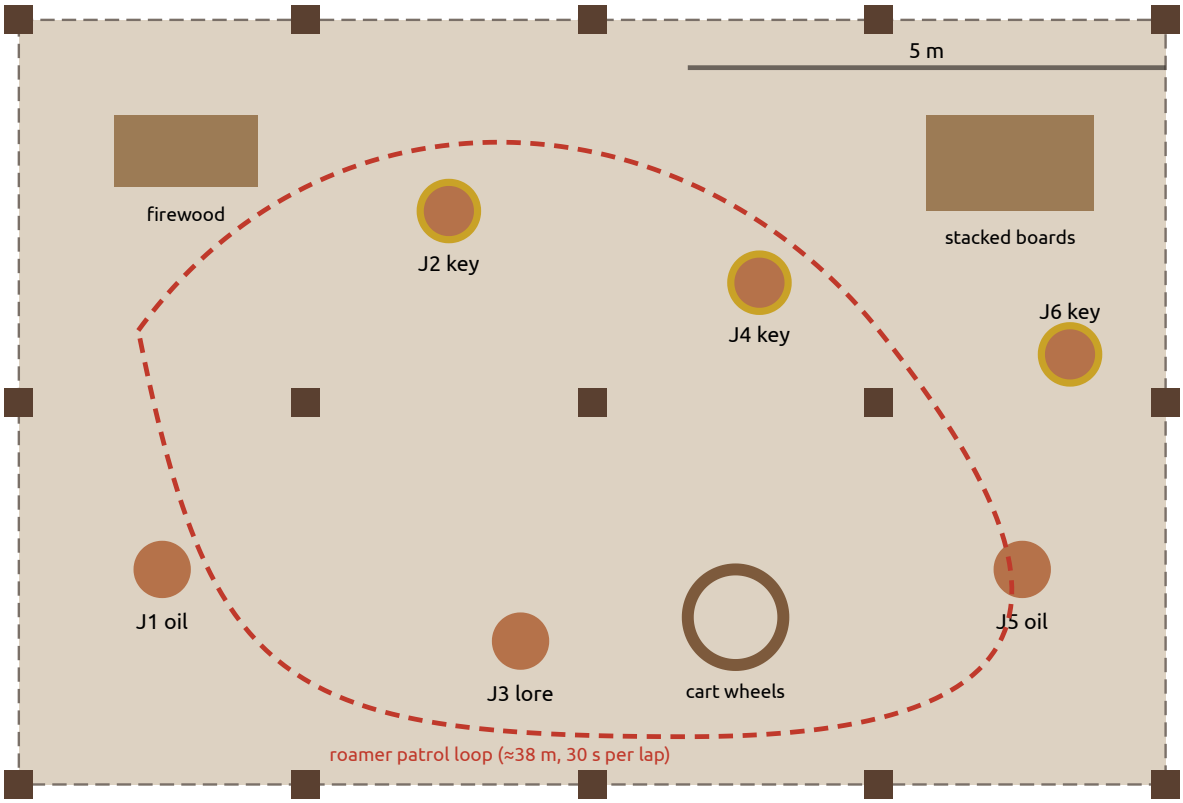
Courtyard 24 × 18 m. The tent sits 2 m in front of the house so that light from the tent spills under the stilts. The dashed red line is the protective thread.

4.3 Upper house



Upper floor 12 × 8 m, raised 2.5 m. Floorboards have 1 cm gaps (light and shadow pass through). Red dashed line: the hallway walker's route in beat A2-06. H1 and H2 are hiding wardrobes.

4.4 Under the house



entry from the tent side (south) · CP5

Under-house area 12 × 8 m, 2.5 m clearance, 15 pillars on a 3 × 4 m grid. Gold rings mark the three jars holding key fragments. The roamer's loop passes within 2 m of every jar, so each search needs timing.

05 Item Placement

Item	Qty	Location(s)	Notes
Oil bottle (refills 100%)	7	Kitchen (1), hall shelf (1), Sok's room (1), tent bench (1), jars J1 and J5 (2), shed (2; optional)	A full tank lasts ~12 min. Expect 5–6 refills needed.
Matches	10 + 10	Start with 10; a second box in the kitchen drawer	Sanctified matches are separate.
Incense bundle	∞	House altar (re-collectable bundle of 4)	One bundle replaces all four corner sticks.
Betel leaves, areca nut	1 each	Kitchen	Betel puzzle.
Lime pot	1	Hall shelf	Betel puzzle.
Candle, incense (tray)	1 each	Altar	Betel puzzle.
Sanctified matches	3	Reward (A1-09)	Spare at the altar if all are used.
Shed key	1	Sewing box, hall	Optional.
Drawer key	1	Base of the hall altar	From the gramophone clue.
Key fragments	3	Jars J2, J4, J6	Combine in the satchel.
Lore notes L1–L5	5	L1 altar drawer · L2 jar J3 · L3 Sok's wardrobe · L4 land deed (shed) · L5 Kanha's photograph (shed)	Text in the Episode 1 Script.

06 Threat Specifications

Property	Neak Ta shadow · house (A2-06)	Neak Ta shadow · under-house (A3)	Presence (A3-07)
Behaviour	Scripted route (map 4.3); pauses 4 s at Sok's door; leaves	Patrol loop; investigates noise; drawn to open lamplight	Scripted; stands behind Sora
Speed	1.0 m/s (slow, dragging)	1.3 m/s patrol · 2.4 m/s chase	—
Hearing	Radius 6 m for a normal step; 2 m crouched	Radius 8 m normal; 3 m crouched; jar lid 7 m	—
Sight	None	Sees an open lamp within 10 m; a shuttered or dark Sora within 1.5 m	—
Catch	Touching Sora, or Sora in the open within 1.5 m	Reaching Sora	Camera turned >100° from the burner
On catch	Short scare (1.5 s), fade, a torn sketchbook page, restart at the last checkpoint		

07 Checkpoints and Flags

CP	Beat	Restores
CP1	P07	Start of Act I at the carriage, full lamp
CP2	A2-01	Under the tent after the lamps go out
CP3	A2-06	Inside Sok's room, just before the walker
CP4	A3-01	Under the tent after the thread snaps
CP5	A3-03	Entry to the under-house area (fragments already found are kept)
CP6	A3-07	At the burner with the token

Checkpoints restore oil to at least 50% so the player never restarts in an unwinnable state.

Flag	Set by	Used for
`ep1.letters.taken`	P03	Lore count
`ep1.vuthy.left`	A1-04	Story
`ep1.betel.done` / `ep1.betel.firstTry`	A1-09	Respect +1 (first try)
`ep1.incense.neglected`	Incense out for 60+ s outside A2-09	Respect +1 if never set
`ep1.shed.opened`	A1-11	Lore
`ep1.gramophone.solved`	A2-05	Progress
`ep1.fragments.count` (0–3)	A3-04	Progress
`ep1.seal1.broken`	A3-08	Episode 5 remnant
`ep1.journal.shared`	R02	Vuthy dialogue in Eps 3–5
`lore.ep1.L1` … `L5`	Pickups	Knowledge (chant lines)

08 Greybox Checklist

Phase 2 is complete when every item below works with placeholder shapes.

✓	Item
□	All four areas blocked out at the dimensions above; the player can walk every route
□	All beats P01–R05 trigger in order, with placeholder text for dialogue
□	Lamp oil, matches and the incense timer work; checkpoints restore correctly
□	Betel tray, gramophone, drawer, fragments, chest and ritual puzzles are completable
□	Walker and roamer follow their specs; catching restarts at the right checkpoint
□	Corpse poses change when unwatched
□	All flags are set and saved; the dawn choice is stored
□	A first-time tester finishes in 1 h 35 – 1 h 55 and reports being scared at least twice